Johnson's irritation about the lack of support on Vietnam from Pakistan also ended up affecting India adversely. Annoyed with Pakistan's deepening relations with China and the Soviet Union and with its reticence on Vietnam, Johnson indefinitely postponed Ayub's visit scheduled for spring 1965.[191] Washington's hyphenation of its India-Pakistan policies meant a similarly scheduled Shastri visit became collateral damage and was also postponed. The manner of the cancellation of his visit left Shastri humiliated. Indian officials dismissed the American explanation that he would have been forced to speak out on Vietnam if he had traveled to Washington. B. K. Nehru later called the indefinite postponement a "colossal bloomer" connected to "the annoying policy of equating Pakistan with India."[192] It came at an inopportune time for Shastri.[193] The prime minister was still fending off challengers domestically, including some who accused him of weakness. Earlier in the spring he also had to deal with major language riots in southern India and the related resignation of two ministers. In addition, Kashmiri leader Sheikh Abdullah, on tour abroad, had been making statements unfriendly to India.[194] Moreover, the US trip cancellation came just as the Pakistani army seemed to be challenging India in the Rann of Kutch (at the Gujarat-Sindh border) in April 1965.

The clash in the Rann followed Sino-Pakistan talks, and Indian officials were concerned that it was a result of Sino-Pakistani collusion.[195] Delhi saw Chinese statements during the skirmish as incitement at best and threatening at worst, and dismissed Beijing's allegation that India was "carrying out the 'US scheme of making Asians fight Asians.'"[196] What made matters worse from the Indian perspective was that Pakistan used American-supplied equipment. Officials complained that the US was not living up to its promise that it would not allow this equipment to be used against India unless it unquestionably attacked Pakistan.[197] To many in India, the American inability to exercise control called into question the reliability of US assurances about the use of such weapons, as well as whether the US could really be relied on to restrain Pakistan in the case of a larger war between India and China or India and China-Pakistan.

An American assessment acknowledged that, given deepening Sino-Pakistan relations and the 1962 Chinese defeat of India, the Shastri government could not afford to back down against Pakistan.[198] But Johnson's patience seemed to reach a breaking point as he questioned both